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Hiring Team, Growth — Topsort

Growth at adtech-for-marketplaces is a buyer-education problem before it's a channel problem. The marketplace VP of Monetization who'd buy Topsort doesn't Google "retail media platform" at 11pm. She reads a Decibel-style teardown a peer forwarded her, watches one founder talk at IRCE, and then takes a meeting six months later because someone she trusts said it worked. Performance marketing on cold audiences is the wrong instinct here. The interesting growth lever is compressing the education cycle — making the case once, in a format that travels through that buyer's network without you in the room.

I'm useful for this in a way that's unusual: **I've run retail-media campaigns from the buyer side, and I've been on the other side of the platform-sale conversation.**

At Pixis I spent 14 months running campaigns on an AI adtech B2B SaaS platform — \$1.4M in budget across global D2C and e-commerce clients, an 8-person team, weekly optimization cycles. Retail media was a core part of the mix for those D2C clients. I'm Amazon Retail Ads + Amazon Sponsored Ads + Criteo certified because I actually ran them. I know what makes a marketplace operator nod (concrete ROAS lifts on a comparable account, holdout incrementality math, clear story on creative iteration). I know what makes them roll their eyes (hand-wavy "AI" claims, dashboards that show effort rather than outcome, case studies clearly written by someone who's never run a campaign). That perspective doesn't come from reading about adtech — it comes from living inside both sides of it.

Three other things worth knowing:

Founder-mode is muscle memory, not aspiration. I built SwipeHire from zero-to-one this year — two-sided AI marketplace, instrumented the funnel before launch (GA4, GTM, event tracking, cohort dashboards), ran 8+ A/B tests on activation, lifted activation 25%. The hardest part wasn't shipping; it was deciding what to ship and what to ignore when there's no PRD inbox. That's the same prioritization muscle a Series-stage growth role lives on every day.

Growth infrastructure is something I've actually built. At Plug Power I stood up the full MarTech stack from scratch — Salesforce + Adobe Analytics + GA + GTM — and got sales and marketing to agree on what a "lead" actually meant before writing a single rule. -25% CPA, +20% conversion. Your JD calls this "growth infrastructure through metrics definition." That's literally the job I did.

The 4-day onsite in Somerville works — I'm Boston-based and think early-stage growth roles benefit from being in the room when founders make brand-defining calls. First 30 days for me would be deep on Topsort's positioning vs Criteo Commerce Yield, Mirakl Ads, and Moloco — I want to ramp by sitting in on prospect calls before I write copy.

Resume + portfolio: adhithyabhaskar.vercel.app/ref/topsort

Would love 15-20 min to hear what the team's biggest funnel-bottleneck conversation looks like right now.

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